

Build4All Sales and Order Analytics Policy

Controlled knowledge source for multilingual Text to SQL retrieval

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Authoritative schema	build4all_research
Status	Controlled research source
Scope	Orders, revenue, discounts, payment amounts, shipping amounts, and tax

Purpose and authority

This document defines the business meanings that the Build4All retrieval system may provide to the SQL generator. It applies only to the frozen build4all_research PostgreSQL schema. The definitions below are authoritative for the controlled experiment and must remain aligned with the benchmark gold queries.

Order status vocabulary

The orders.status field may represent completed, shipped, pending, processing, cancelled, or refunded orders. A recognized order is an order whose status is completed or shipped. A rule that requests all orders or a breakdown by status must not silently apply the recognized-order filter.

Authoritative metric rules

Recognized order revenue

Recognized order revenue is the sum of orders.total_amount for orders whose status is completed or shipped. The total amount is the final stored order amount and may include merchandise after discount, shipping, and tax. Apply only the grouping dimension explicitly requested, such as customer region or calendar month.

Gross merchandise value

Gross merchandise value is the sum of orders.subtotal for every order whose status is not cancelled. For this metric, shipped, completed, pending, processing, and refunded records remain included unless the benchmark definition is revised. Do not replace subtotal with total_amount.

Net merchandise sales

Net merchandise sales equal the sum of `orders.subtotal` minus `orders.discount_amount` for recognized orders only. Recognized orders have status completed or shipped. Shipping and tax are not part of this metric.

Average order value

Average order value is the average of `orders.total_amount` across recognized orders. Include completed and shipped orders only. Do not require a coupon, active flag, payment row, or product join.

Order count by status

Order count by status counts every order and groups by `orders.status`. No order status is excluded. Each order is counted once.

Operational backlog

The operational backlog is the count of orders whose status is pending or processing. Completed, shipped, cancelled, and refunded orders are excluded from backlog.

Cancellation rate

Cancellation rate percent is one hundred multiplied by the number of orders with status cancelled divided by the number of all orders. The denominator includes every order status. Return a null-safe percentage when the denominator is zero.

Refunded order count

Refunded order count is the count of orders whose `orders.status` is refunded. This order-status metric is separate from refunded payment records.

Daily order volume

Daily order volume counts all orders for each calendar date in the requested interval. Unless the question says recognized orders, do not add a status filter. For August 2026, include timestamps from 2026-08-01 00:00:00 UTC and exclude timestamps at or after 2026-09-01 00:00:00 UTC.

Recognized coupon discount

Recognized discount amount by coupon is the sum of `orders.discount_amount` for orders linked to each coupon and having status completed or shipped. Coupon activity or validity is not an additional filter unless the question requests currently valid coupons.

Recognized product sales by category

Recognized product sales by category are calculated from `order_items.quantity` multiplied by `order_items.unit_price`. Join `order_items` to `orders` by `order_id`, to `products` by `product_id`, and to `categories` by `category_id`. Include orders with status completed or shipped.

Recognized shipping amount

Recognized shipping amount by shipping method is the sum of `orders.shipping_amount` for completed and shipped orders. Join `orders` to `shipping_methods` using `shipping_method_id`.

Effective tax rate

Effective tax rate percent for recognized orders is one hundred multiplied by the sum of `orders.tax_amount` divided by the sum of `orders.subtotal` minus `orders.discount_amount`. Include completed and shipped orders only and protect against a zero denominator.

Payment amount rules

Collected paid amount

Sum `payments.paid_amount` for payment records whose `payment_status` is paid. Group by `payments.payment_method` when requested.

Pending payment amount

The outstanding amount for pending payments is the sum of `payments.paid_amount` where `payment_status` is pending.

Failed payment rate

Failed payment rate percent is one hundred multiplied by the number of payment records whose `payment_status` is failed divided by the number of all payment records.

Refunded payment amount

Refunded payment amount is the sum of `payments.paid_amount` where `payment_status` is refunded. Do not confuse this with `orders.status`.

Paid payment mismatch

A paid payment mismatches its related order when the absolute difference between `payments.paid_amount` and `orders.total_amount` is greater than 0.01. Join payments to orders using `order_id`.

Disambiguation rules

- Use `orders.total_amount` for recognized order revenue and average order value.
- Use `orders.subtotal` for gross merchandise value.
- Use `orders.subtotal` minus `orders.discount_amount` for net merchandise sales.
- Use `order_items.quantity` multiplied by `order_items.unit_price` for product sales by category.
- Never add coupon, product-status, payment-status, or active filters unless the requested metric requires them.
- Never join tables that are not needed by the requested fields, grouping, filter, or metric.

Research governance

This is a synthetic controlled research policy, not an audited production finance policy. Any change to a definition, schema field, status value, time boundary, or join must create a new version and must be reflected in the benchmark gold SQL before evaluation. Benchmark questions and expected result values are intentionally excluded from this retrieval document.